

Safety Principles for Herbal Supplements & Natural Products

Complementary health products, including botanical herbs and dietary supplements, should be used with caution and informed awareness.

Key Safety Rules: 1. Disclosure: Always inform your healthcare provider about any dietary supplements, herbs, or natural products you are taking. 2. Drug Interactions: Natural products can interact with prescription medications (e.g., blood thinners, blood pressure drugs, diabetes medicines). 3. Quality & Purity: Natural products are not regulated in the same way as prescription medicines. Contamination or dosage variability may occur in uncertified products. 4. Avoid During Pregnancy: Pregnant or breastfeeding individuals should avoid herbal supplements unless explicitly cleared by their physician.

Common Natural Products & Evidence Status

Overview of common dietary products: - Ginger: Evidence supports ginger for mild nausea related to motion or pregnancy. Use in moderate food-level amounts. - Chamomile: Commonly used as tea for mild relaxation. Caution in individuals allergic to ragweed. - Peppermint Oil: Enteric-coated peppermint oil may ease mild IBS symptoms. Avoid unformulated raw oil ingestion.

Adverse Reaction Reporting & Red Flags

If you experience rash, nausea, rapid heart rate, or dizziness after taking a natural product, discontinue use immediately and seek medical evaluation.

Evaluating Online Health Information

Rely on science-based sources like NIH NCCIH, FDA, and MedlinePlus when researching natural products online.